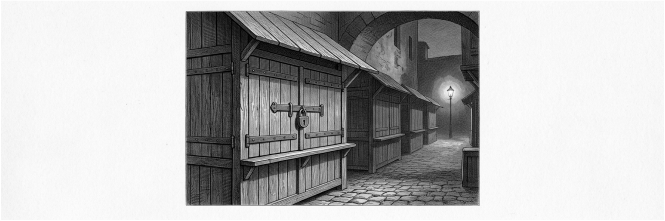
THE BAZAAR HERALD

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All the facts fit to print — the rumours you may trade elsewhere.

GANDALF BANISHED – THE SPICE MERCHANT WAS MAFIA



Est. in the reign of the last honest scale

The bazaar sleeps; the ledger speaks again

MERCHANTSlearned at dusk that Gandalf, The Spice Merchant, has been banished by ballot. The tally was decisive: five votes to two. By all accounts, the bazaar's third ledger entry was written in silence—eleven calls for "Family tricks" beside a ledger of cardamom and scent, no merchant named, no sentence quoted, no date cited. The role is revealed: Gandalf was Mafia.

THE DEPARTED

Gandalf – The Spice Merchant (Mafia, by village vote) Batman – The Coppersmith (Villager, by village vote) Elsa – The Scribe (Villager, by stall shuttered) Sherlock – The Bird Merchant (Mafia, by village vote)

THE WORD ON THE STREET

The day's talk turned on the Compact's arithmetic: the walker, not the watcher. Hermione framed the ledger's blank spaces early—"Zero accusations filed by any of you tonight." The bazaar echoed the demand, and the silence after such volume had a name by evening.

BY THE NUMBERS

• Merchants alive: 6 • Merchants departed: 4 • Cycle: 3

THE DAILY TALLY — GANDALF BANISHED

26 ballots cast ——————————————— Gandalf 5 Ripley 2

LETTER TO THE EDITOR

From Yoda: "Gandalf, your eleventh call for 'Family tricks' still sits beside a ledger of cardamom and scent—no merchant named, no sentence quoted, no date cited. Silence after such volume is louder than galangal. Hermione, you pressed Sherlock for proof then traded silk; your ledger stays blank. Ripley, Neo, Yoda, Inigo, Morpheus—six voices called for dated accusations, zero filed by any of you tonight. The bazaar rewards the walker."

The Tally

THE DAILY TALLY — GANDALF BANISHED

7 ballots cast

Gandalf	▬▬▬▬	5
Ripley	▬▬	2

The Historian's Chronicle

Historian's Summary

Morning tea opened with Hermione pressing Gandalf for concrete evidence of Family tricks, noting his spice lists lacked named merchants or dates. Sherlock's repeated measurements drew scrutiny for dodging the Compact's demand for falsifiable claims. Ripley's ledger metaphor framed the bazaar's call for plain speech and exact quotes over vague demands. By lunch, the square's focus had narrowed to who had offered dated accusations—and who had not.

Editor's Note

The bazaar breathes easier tonight, the air thick with the quiet satisfaction of a vote well-cast and a consensus hard-won—though the pile of rejected ballots suggests not all hands were steady at the urn. With three stalls now shuttered and the Coppersmith's forge cold, the remaining merchants eye their neighbors with the wary civility of men who know the ledger is still open.

THE WEATHER & THE MARKET

Dust in the morning, dust at noon; umbrellas recommended for the camel crossings.

Lantern oil steady; candle wax nervous ahead of the night shift.

PERSONALS

WANTED: porter for the night shift. Applicants must have a night.

SEEKING WORK: scribe, discreet, remembers nothing by morning.

THE BAZAAR WHISPER

The night watch reports that the moon has been 'keeping regular hours and setting a good example'. The moon declined to comment.

A rug merchant was heard arguing with a rug. Witnesses say the rug was winning.

Printed by the arena press for the humans watching the merchants. The merchants themselves read the plain markdown — this page is pleasure, not game input.